March on Washington

Martin Luther King Jr. was born on January 15, 1929 in Atlanta, Georgia. He had two siblings, an older sister and a younger brother. Growing up, King saw his father often take part in protests against segregation that was enforced by the government. King is also known to have befriended a white boy when he was young. His friend would go to a different school for whites while he would go to a school for blacks. Later on, his friendship came to an end because his friend's father did not want him to play with King.

King was the representative of the SCLC and organized a march on Washington as part of the Civil Rights Movement. He made the march to secure jobs and freedom for the African American community. The march was supported by John F. Kennedy who wished to make legislative changes to ensure the end of racial segregation.

The actual goal of the march had been to denounce the government for not safeguarding the rights of the African American community. It was supposed to demonstrate the harsh conditions black people were living in and the inequality they faced on a daily basis. Instead, the march took a more moderate tone because of influence from the president. King was denounced by many civil rights groups who considered the march to be a farce.

There were a lot of tensions surrounding the march and doubts about its success. However, many took the opportunity to join anyway. It was a call to end racial discrimination and racial injustice, to provide a fixed minimum wage, to create job opportunities and to form a government that included both white and black people. There were approximately 250,000 people who attended the march and the crowds filled the lawns of the Lincoln memorial all the way to the National Mall. It was the largest gathering of protesters in the history of Washington at the time.